DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

(VITyarthi)

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Introduction

This project was completed as part of the Digital Literacy VITyarthi project, where I took on the role of a ‘Student Digital Ambassador’. The objective of this project was to develop a comprehensive digital literacy portfolio that demonstrates my understanding of digital skills required in academic and professional environments.

Through five tasks, I explored areas such as creating digital awareness infographics, building a professional online presence, using coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional communication, and cybercrime awareness. Each task contributed to improving my ability to navigate the digital world effectively.

This project not only enhanced my technical skills but also helped me develop critical thinking, communication, and online safety awareness, which are essential for my future academic and professional journey.

Task 1

For Task 1, I created a ‘Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic’ using Canva. The infographic was designed as a visual resource aimed at helping students understand the concept and importance of digital literacy.

My design covered three key topics:

1. What digital literacy is
2. Useful digital tools for students
3. Safe internet practices

I structured the infographic with headings and concise text to make it visually appealing and easy to understand. The goal was to ensure that even someone with no prior knowledge could quickly grasp the essentials of digital literacy.

One challenge I faced was balancing visual design with content clarity. It was difficult to include enough information without overcrowding the layout. This helped me learn how to prioritize important points and present them effectively. Overall, this task improved my design thinking and ability to communicate information visually.

Task 2

In Task 2, I built my digital portfolio by creating profiles on Kaggle, ResearchGate, and Stack Overflow.

Kaggle is used for data science learning and competitions, ResearchGate is useful for academic networking and research sharing, and Stack Overflow helps developers solve coding-related problems through community discussions.

Setting up these profiles helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional digital presence.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use these platforms to enhance my skills. I aim to participate in Kaggle competitions, explore research topics on ResearchGate, and contribute to discussions on Stack Overflow. This will not only improve my knowledge but also help me build a strong online portfolio for internships and job opportunities.

Task 3

For Task 3, I explored coding and collaboration platforms. I completed beginner-level challenges on HackerRank, where I earned two badges by solving problems. This helped me strengthen my basic python programming and problem-solving skills.

In addition, I created a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using Google Forms. The quiz included five questions, with a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer types. It was designed to test basic awareness of digital literacy among students.

This task helped me understand how coding platforms can improve thinking and how collaboration tools like Google Forms can be used for academic purposes such as quizzes, surveys etc. These tools will be highly useful in my academic journey. HackerRank will help me prepare for coding interviews, while Google Forms can be used for projects and research.

Task 4

In this task, I practised professional communication by writing two formal emails and creating a social media etiquette checklist.

A common example of poor digital communication is when a student sends an email to a professor without a proper subject line, greeting, or clear message. For instance, a student might write “Send deadline plz” without context or politeness. Such emails can be ignored or misunderstood.

In academic and professional environments, first impressions matter, and poorly written communication can harm credibility.

This situation could have been handled better by using a clear subject line, a polite greeting, and a structured message explaining the request properly.

Task 5

While researching cybercrime, I focused on ransomware attacks and how they affect individuals and organizations. One thing that surprised me was how quickly a system can be locked and made unusable after downloading a malicious file or clicking an unsafe link. Many ransomware attacks spread through simple actions like opening email attachments or visiting insecure websites.

I also found it concerning that victims are often forced to pay large amounts of money to regain access to their own data, with no guarantee of recovery.

As a result of this task, one habit I will change is being more cautious about downloading files and opening email attachments from unknown sources. I will also make sure to regularly back up my data so that even if an attack occurs, I do not lose important information. To be able to stay safe online, I also created a simple checklist to be vigilant, aware and prepared whenever online.

Conclusion

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and its importance in today's world. Through practical tasks, I developed skills in design, online presence building, coding, communication, and cybersecurity awareness.

Each task contributed to enhancing my confidence in using digital tools effectively and responsibly. I also gained valuable insights into maintaining professionalism in online interactions and protecting myself from cyber threats.

References

- Canva
- Kaggle
- ResearchGate
- Stack Overflow
- HackerRank
- Google Forms